

Thomas Alvarez

ABOUT ME

SDET with 9 years in QA/Testing, currently at Cisco. I work at the point where architecture meets delivery: setting technical direction, then staying close enough to the code to know whether it held. Strongest in Jira, JavaScript and Selenium.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Cisco — SDET

January 2023 to May 2026

- Built the defect triage process and reporting the engineering leads still use.
- Drove accessibility coverage from 8% to 94% of core journeys.
- Automated 40 regression suites with Java, cutting the manual test cycle by 35%.
- Established test data management practices later adopted by 6 teams.
- Wrote the team's testing strategy, separating unit, contract and end-to-end responsibilities.

Quality Engineer, Ironwood Consulting

February 2018 to August 2022

- Integrated automated checks into the Kubernetes pipeline, blocking 5 faulty releases.
- Mentored 5 manual testers into automation roles.
- Reduced escaped defects by 12% through risk-based test prioritisation.
- Owned release sign-off for 8 services, coordinating across product and support.

Quality Engineer, Northbridge IT

November 2016 to October 2017

- Built a performance harness in Cypress simulating 5k concurrent users.
- Partnered with developers to shift testing left, embedding QA in refinement sessions.
- Set up cross-browser and device coverage in Selenium, catching defects staging had missed.

Ironwood Consulting — Junior SDET

April 2016 to September 2016

- Introduced flaky-test quarantine, taking suite reliability from 30% to 90%.
- Cut end-to-end suite runtime from 30 hours to 12 minutes through parallelisation.
- Ran retrospectives and drove the follow-up actions to completion, not just to the board.

ACADEMIC BACKGROUND

Bachelor, Communications

North Garmouth National University | 2016

Cum Laude

TECHNOLOGIES

Jira, JavaScript, Selenium, GitHub Actions, Cypress, Java, Node.js, Kubernetes, Tableau

NOTABLE PROJECTS

Commute optimiser

Pulls transit APIs and suggests departure times, built on GitHub Actions.

TRAINING & CERTIFICATIONS

Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305) — Microsoft, 2021

AWS Certified Developer - Associate — Amazon Web Services, 2022

COMMUNITY

STEM ambassador running school workshops twice a term.

LANGUAGE SKILLS

English – C2

Turkish – Conversational

Dutch – Basic (A2)